

Ateneo de Davao University  
**ARRUPE OFFICE OF SOCIAL FORMATION**  
Seniors' Integration Program (SIP)

**Character Assessment Tool**  
*Reflective Ignatian Leadership*

**For Self-Assessment, Peer Assessment, and Formator Assessment**

**Instructions:**

Make a brief assessment of your practice of Reflective Leadership. Although there is no required score, you may want to use the guide to bring you closer to the “strongly agree” levels for each statement.

|                                                                                                 | <b>Strongly Agree</b> | <b>Agree</b> | <b>Disagree</b> | <b>Strongly Disagree</b> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------|-----------------|--------------------------|
| I regularly reflect on the events of my day and how they affect me.                             | ✓                     |              |                 |                          |
| I have developed a habit of reflecting on my inner experiences.                                 | ✓                     |              |                 |                          |
| I have been able to identify my default feelings (joy, anger, sadness, fear).                   |                       | ✓            |                 |                          |
| I have been able to identify my automatic thoughts.                                             |                       | ✓            |                 |                          |
| Identifying my default feelings and automatic thoughts helps me better understand my reactions. |                       | ✓            |                 |                          |
| I have been able to name my strongest needs and the things that I am strongly attached to.      |                       | ✓            |                 |                          |
| I have learned to forgive myself for my weaknesses and shortcomings.                            |                       | ✓            |                 |                          |
| I am making progress in accepting myself, including my shadows.                                 |                       |              | ✓               |                          |
| Self-understanding and acceptance are helping me better manage my emotions and actions.         |                       | ✓            |                 |                          |

## **THREE BIG IDEAS ABOUT REFLECTIVE LEADERSHIP**

### **Three-Sentence Summary**

My assessment shows that I consistently practice reflection, especially in looking back on my daily experiences and understanding my inner thoughts and emotions. I am able to identify my feelings and recognize how they influence my reactions, which helps me manage my actions more effectively. However, while I am making progress, I still find it difficult to fully accept myself and forgive my shortcomings, so I need to continue working on self-acceptance and being less critical of myself.

### **Big Idea #1: One non-negotiable responsibility of Ignatian Leaders is to themselves—to nurture their Self and Spirit.**

We cannot lead others unless we are able to lead ourselves. It is essential that Leaders nurse a deep and constant connection to their inner selves—a connection that can be attained only when we learn to live within, to pay attention to the mysterious universe within us. We have to be courageous and patient so that we can inhabit this inner world and nurture ourselves not only psychologically but also spiritually.

### **Big Idea #2: Leading with Depth begins with reflecting on our experiences**

Ignatian discernment may be conceived of as having three ingredients: Reflecting on our Experience, Discerning our Response, and Praying for Confirmation. Reflective Leadership focuses on the first—and the most psychological—of these three. We reflect not only on external events, but more importantly, on our inner experiences, which include our thoughts, feelings, and needs. Self-understanding and acceptance can help free us from our personal baggage and inordinate attachments. It helps us attain the freedom needed for us to manage and master ourselves.

### **Big Idea #3: The practice of Reflective Leadership can bring Emotional Efficacy and Emotional Ease.**

Ignatian Leadership requires the habit of Reflection and compassion in order to achieve self-understanding and acceptance. By understanding our default feelings, our automatic thoughts, and our most powerful needs, we get to know ourselves better and—when tempered by compassion for ourselves—to accept who we are. Adequate self-awareness and a healthy

trust in ourselves can help us treat ourselves as a friend rather than a stranger, an enemy, or servant.

**Reference:**

Go, J. & Cuyegkeng, A. C. (2024). Leading with Depth: A Practitioner's Guide to 21st-Century Ignatian Leadership- Quezon City: Bluebooks, an imprint of Ateneo de Manila University Press